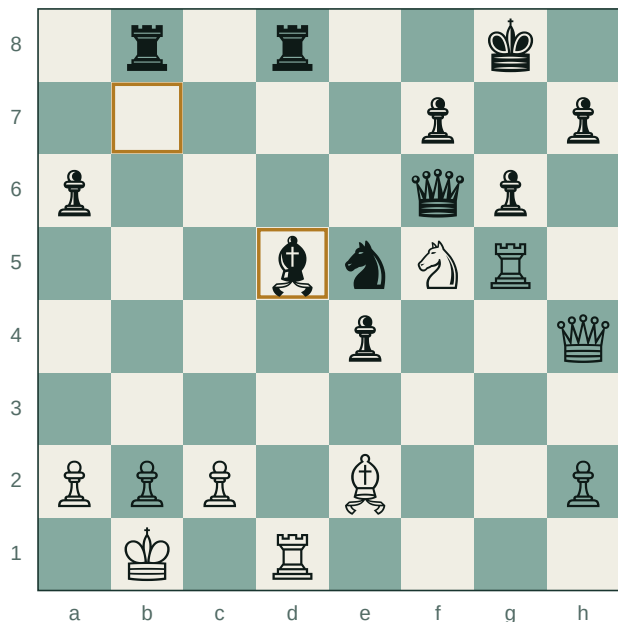


Attraction tactics: White, move 28

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...Bd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Rxc6+ Qxc6 29. Ne7+ Kg7 30. Nxc6

28.Rxc6+ Check restricts Black to 7 legal replies here. From g6 it attacks king on g8 and queen on f6. Recorded reply: **28...Qxc6**.

29.Ne7+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From e7 it attacks king on g8, queen on g6 and bishop on d5. Recorded reply: **29...Kg7**.

30.Nxc6 The knight captures the queen on g6. The changed line means the queen on h4 attacks the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 20 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.